8.6.5 Uses of Enzymes

Enzyme	Source	Application
Bacterial protease	*Bacillus*	Biological detergents
Bacterial glucose isomerase	*Bacillus*	Fructose syrup manufacture
Fungal lactase	*Kluyveromyces*	Breaking down of lactose to glucose and galactose
Amylases	*Aspergillus*	Removal of starch in woven cloth production

8.7 Nucleic Acids

As we know DNA and RNA are the two kinds of nucleic acids. These were originally isolated from cell nucleus. They are present in all known **cells** and **viruses** with special coded genetic programme with detailed and specific instructions for each organism heredity.

DNA and RNA are polymers of monomers called **nucleotides**, each of which is composed of a nitrogen base, a pentose sugar and a phosphate. A purine or a pyrimidine and a ribose or deoxyribose sugar is called **nucleoside**. A nitrogenous base is linked to pentose sugar through n-glycosidic linkage and forms a nucleoside. When a phosphate group is attached to a nucleoside it is called a **nucleotide**. The nitrogen base is a heterocyclic compound that can be either a **purine** (two rings) or a **pyrimidine** (one ring). There are **2 types of purines – adenine (A) and guanine (G) and 3 types of pyrimidines – cytosine (C), thymine (T) and uracil (U)** (Figure 8.20 and 21)**.**

A characteristic feature that differentiates DNA from RNA is that DNA contains nitrogen bases such as Adenine, guanine, thymine (5-methyl uracil) and cytosine and the RNA contains nitrogen bases such as adenine, guanine, cytosine and uracil instead of thymine. The nitrogen base is covalently bonded to the sugar ribose in RNA and to deoxyribose (ribose with one oxygen removed from C_2) in DNA. Phosphate group is a derivative of (PO_4^{3-}) phosphoric acid, and forms phosphodiester linkages with sugar molecule (Figure 8.22).

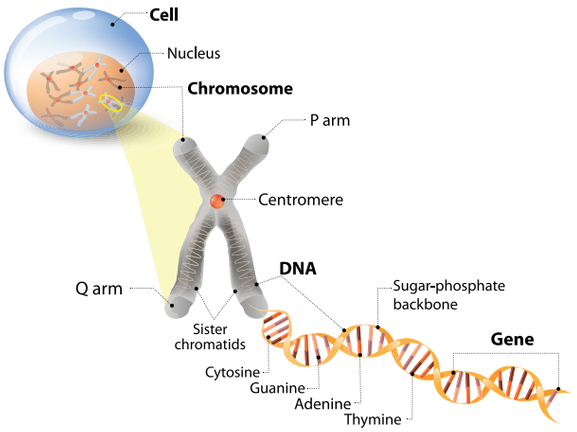


Figure 8.20: Position of DNA in the cell

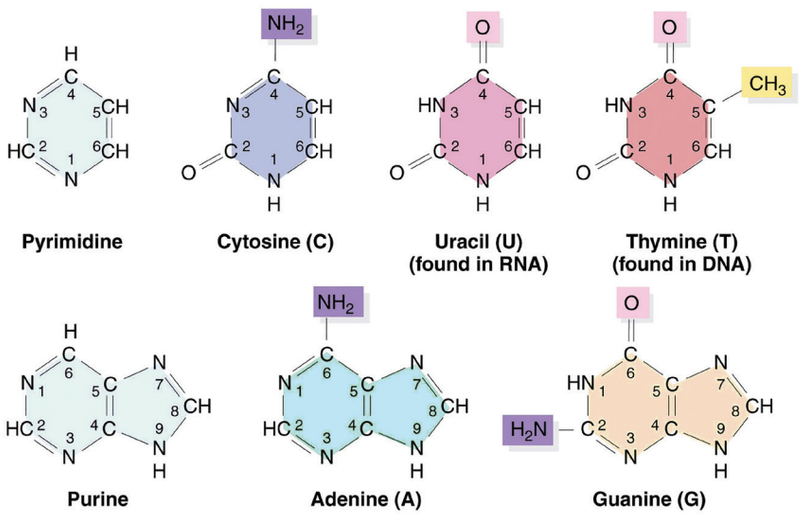


Figure 8.21: Structure of nucleic acid component



Telomerase - A ribonucleic Protein.

Telomere protects the end of the chromosomes from damage. Telomerase is a ribonucleo protein also called as terminal transferase.

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